

SKOAR!

FARCRY3

Deadly paradise adventure

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Far Cry 3 is a potent and heady mixture. You escape from Vaas (for now) and are left to piece together your course of action, alone and out of your comfort zone. Whatever Jason has to do, the (in-game) universe couldn't have picked a more picturesque location for him in. If there's one thing in Far Cry 3 that really shines in all its splendour it has to be the environment you play the game in. Not only full of steep mountains, decked with rivers and waterfalls, Rook Island is abuzz with all kinds of life – exotic plants and animals, both on land and in water. It's really hard not to get lost in this lush, green paradise, and explore it all. You never know what you'll encounter, at least for the first few hours of gameplay, and that's the beauty of Far Cry 3's sandbox environment.

As far as gameplay is concerned, Far Cry 3 juggles various core elements pretty well. First-person shooting is standard stuff, but elements of RPG help unlock new skill sets for Jason – extended breath underwater to taking down two enemies at once. Stealth mechanics of the game are almost exactly same as those in Assassin's Creed III – a meter starts filling if you're directly within an enemy's field of vision and range – hiding

wipes it clean, while the meter fills if the enemy's discovered your location. It's great fun alternating between a sneaky assassin that kills in stealth or meeting a small army headlong with explosive armaments, both style of gameplay are rewarding.

Capturing enemy outposts is a large chunk of Far Cry 3's non-linear mini game offering, and while each outpost is different from another, the act of capturing them quickly loses its draw and just becomes a bit of "going through the motions". Far Cry 3 also requires you to locate and climb atop radio towers strewn across the island to unlock them on the map (and score other bonuses), which can also get a bit too repetitive.

Far Cry 3 has an iconic villain in the form of Vaas, who's totally nuts, and his now popular monologue on "the definition of insanity" promises to be a cult hit. Keeping you immersed in the game is a very good soundtrack of jungle beats, quick tempo tracks and suspense-filled tunes that start and end at just the right time, always true to the mood of the game – there's plenty of silence in there, too – it's brilliant.

AI is quite intelligent in Far Cry 3, whether it's human or beast and we didn't encounter any bugs while playing this game on a PS3. Competitive multiplayer mode isn't as absorbing as Far Cry 3's single-player campaign. However, what

you will spend hours playing is undoubtedly its multiplayer map editor mode. ★

Verdict

Far Cry 3 is one wild and crazy ride through a tropical paradise hiding a dark and sinister story. Combining themes like exploration and survival, the game proceeds at a great pace, heightening the amount of fun before multiple climaxes that bring the ride to an abrupt (and untimely) end. Whether you're a fan of the franchise or not, this game is definitely worth playing!

MOAR!

- » **Genre:** FPS, action, open-world adventure
- » **Developer:** Ubisoft Montreal
- » **Publisher:** Ubisoft
- » **Price:** PS3, Xbox 360 (₹2,799); PC (₹999)

